

hardware on which its operating system runs which guarantees excellent system performance. Apple also supports the devices over a long duration, in case of an OS update an older device may get a subset of all the upgrades due to the hardware limitations but it still does get the update irrespective of operator.

Android

Android doesn't warrant any introduction. This mobile operating system wunderkind brings together the best of open source and proprietary, closed source software from Google to provide a brilliant platform which continues to revolutionize the mobile industry with nearly 1.5 million device activated everyday. Android constitutes of a kernel based on Linux kernel version 3.x (Android 4.0 Ice Cream Sandwich onwards) or version 2.6 (earlier versions of Android), middleware, libraries and APIs written in C. Android doesn't

behave like a traditional Linux system as it doesn't support X Window System and comes without a lot of standard GNU libraries, so in strictest of terms it is not Linux. Android runs on ARM, x86, MIPS and Freescale's i.MX.



Android 4.2 Jelly Bean on
Nexus 4

The applications run on an application framework which includes libraries based on Apache Harmony, Apache's open source Java implementation. It uses the Dalvik virtual machine with JIT (just in time) compilation to run Dalvik 'dex-code'. The apps are written in Java which are converted to bytecode and then translated to Dalvik 'dex-code' for optimized execution. Dalvik was chosen over the official JVM because it operates better in an embedded environment with improved

CPU utilization and minimum memory usage. The Dalvik VM supports a standard set of core Java APIs. The current stable version of the OS is Android 4.2 Jelly Bean.

Android is used a host of devices from a host of manufacturers across the world, making it impossible to list all the devices that can run Android here. Hardware and Android have always been at odds, the huge disparity in hardware among devices opens a new can of worms, as all of them have to run a different version of the software. Each new update must be specifically tailored to that device and must be made available by the manufacturer. A